



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

jāti.jānapadān dharmān śreṇīdharmāṃś ca dharmavit | 8.41a
samīkṣya kuladharmāṃś ca svadharmaṃ pratipādayet || 41 || 8.41c
svāni karmāṇi kurvāṇā dūre santo 'pi mānavāḥ | 8.42a
priyā bhavanti lokasya sve sve karmaṇy avasthitāḥ || 42 || 8.42c

— Manusmṛti, 8.1.3.7. Judicial Conduct and Reasoning-II (Chapter 7), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Dharma, in its multifaceted glory, is the guiding principle here. This passage from the Manusmriti emphasizes the importance of understanding and upholding various forms of dharma in your life, particularly when making judgments or decisions. It speaks of jāti-dharma, the duties associated with your birth or inherent nature; jānapada-dharma, the customs and laws of your region; śreṇī-dharma, the rules and ethics of your profession or community; and kula-dharma, the traditions of your family. A wise person, a dharmavit, carefully considers all these aspects before guiding others towards their own svadharma – their personal duty and path.

The essence here is that dharma isn't a monolithic concept. It is a tapestry woven from individual, communal, and societal threads. To truly understand dharma, you must appreciate the nuances of each thread and how they interact. This understanding is especially crucial when resolving conflicts or offering guidance, ensuring that solutions are just and harmonious, reflecting the needs of all involved.

The second verse beautifully reinforces the idea that individuals who diligently perform their duties, even when geographically separated, are dear to the world. This highlights the inherent value in fulfilling your responsibilities, regardless of external recognition. When you are steadfast in your svadharma, in your unique contribution to the world, you naturally earn respect and affection. This resonates deeply in our modern, interconnected world where your actions, however small, contribute to the collective good. Consider how your choices impact others and strive to align your actions with your deepest values. By doing so, you not only fulfill your individual purpose but also contribute to a more harmonious and just society. Embracing your svadharma brings inner peace and aligns you with the universal flow of dharma.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you living in alignment with your svadharma, and how can you better integrate the various aspects of dharma into your daily decisions and actions?